

WORKSHOP 1 - SCRIPT

"European ABC: Educational Workshops for Seniors"

1. Basic information

Title of workshop: "**The European Union – A Journey Through Time**"

Authors: Barbara Petersen, Renate Kronemann, Sabine Perisic, Achim Kolbe-Dierks

Duration: 90 min (recommendation 110-120 min)

Number of participants: 19 people

2. Objectives of the workshop

General objective:

The participants should expand their knowledge about the origins of the EU and its development up to the present day and see themselves as part of the European Community.

Specific objectives:

- Activate knowledge recall
- Chronological classification of events that have contributed to the integration of European countries,
- Highlight the guiding principles of the European Community
- Deepen factual knowledge (treaties, accession of countries, dates, etc.)
- Critical reflection on the development of the European Union and the resulting consequences
- contribution of personal experience regarding the EU

3. Description of the target group

This workshop is aimed at people aged 50 and over who are interested in dealing with various topics related to the EU as well as their own European identity. During the workshop they can expand and deepen their knowledge. They will also have the opportunity to discover new perspectives on the EU in conversation and discussion with other participants.

4. Working Methods / Methodical Steps

- Warm-up: spontaneous statements in the round on the topic of the EU
- Presentation of significant milestones on the basis of a timeline on paper, which is already laid out on the table at the beginning of this presentation

- Exchange in small groups on other important events in the development of the EU
- Memory games
- Discussion in the large group to place flags and country names on the timeline
- Final round: "What personal benefit do you see for yourself as an EU citizen?"

5. Materials

Illustrative materials:

- EU institutions as a diagram
- Map of Europe
- Who is who? Clarification of terms: Council of Europe, European Council, Council of the European Union (known as "The Council")

Working materials:

- Timeline with eight milestones
- 21 event cards (short version for the timeline and detailed information on DIN A5 sheets, prepared in envelopes)
- Flags to stick on the timeline
- Memory games
- Glue sticks

6. Workshop agenda

General

- Welcome the participants.
- Reference to the project "Europe can be liked"
- Round of introductions

Introduction

- Introductory words on the content, goal and course of the workshop
- Reference to the EU objective of "Peace and Freedom through Integration" and the fact that this process has not been completed yet.

Duration: 5 min

Main part

Activity 1: Warm-up round

Objective: Establishing a personal connection to the EU

Activity description:

The moderator asks the participants to name only one term one after the other in response to the question "Which word do you associate with the European idea?"

Material: -

Duration: 10 min

Activity 2: Thematic introduction with selected milestones on the development of the European Union

Objective:

Activating memory knowledge and pointing out the historical process that led to the EU as we know it today.

Activity description:

The moderation team presents the concept behind the timeline used and the eight preselected milestones, explaining their significance

Material:

- Timeline on paper with glued on milestones (lies on the table)
- DIN A5 papers with detailed information on the milestones

Duration: 15 min

Note: The in-depth material on the milestones can be used if required.

Activity 3: Deepening the content – further events on EU development

Objective:

Gaining deeper insight into the ongoing EU process and contribute one's own experiences

Activity description:

To further complement the timeline, each participant pulls out an envelope containing the description of an event (on A5) and its short version (header for the timeline).

The participants form small groups to discuss their events and to exchange ideas with each other when these events might have taken place.

The correct chronological order can be viewed on a list on display. The short versions of the events are then glued to the timeline.

Finally, the participants present their events in the round.

Material:

- 21 envelopes with one event each as a short version for the timeline (without indication of the year) as well as a DIN A5 paper with detailed information

Duration: 25 min (recommendation + 15 min)

Note:

The allocated 25 minutes are sufficient for the presentation of the short versions. The more detailed information could then be offered to take away. In order to cover the events on site in more detail, it is recommended to allow 15 minutes more.

Activity 4: Games: Landmarks and EU Member Country Flags Memory Games

Objective:

Get to know the flags of the EU countries, their typical sights and learn about the symbolism of the European flag

Activity description:

To get everyone in the mood for the memory games, the presenter explains the symbolism of the European flag and then briefly explains the rules of the game. Before starting the game the participants form table groups of a maximum of six people. Each group receives a memory game.

Material: Memory games – one game for 4-6 people per group

Duration: 15 min (recommendation + 5 min)

Activity 5: Supplementing the timeline with EU flags and country names

Objective: To recognize the connection between the years when individual countries or groups of countries joined the EU and the global political / pan-European situation

Activity description:

Table templates with the country flags and accession groups are distributed. This will be followed by a discussion among all participants about which countries joined the EU and when, and what political circumstances and intentions were involved. The flags are then placed on the timeline (the years of the accessions are marked on the timeline with a small European flag). Before sticking them onto the timeline, the correct years can be checked against a list provided.

Once the flags have been glued on, the timeline is complete.

Material:

- Table templates with the country flags and accession groups
- Coloured illustrations of all EU country flags in small format to stick on, assorted by enlargement groups, without indication of the dates
- checklist of accessions with countries and years

Duration: 10 min (recommendation + 5 min)

Final round

Participants are asked to briefly express what personal benefit they see for themselves as EU citizens.

Duration: 10-15 min

7. Workshop Evaluation

All participants have completed a feedback form.

The feedback on all parts of the workshop was good to very good. Individual comments regarding content-related deficiencies have already been incorporated into this material.

8. Recommendations

It has been shown that this workshop can be carried out in the planned time of 90 minutes. In order to allow the participants more time for discussion, it is recommended to plan 110-120 minutes.

9. Appendices

- large Map of Europe (photo, EU Website)
- Illustration: 'The EU at a glance' (EU Website)
- Who's who? Definitions: Council of Europe, European Council, Council of the European Union (Council)
- photos of "Timeline"
- Brief descriptions of the eight milestones and detailed information on them
- Checklist of milestones with dates
- Brief descriptions of the 21 events and detailed information on them
- Checklist of events with dates
- Memory games as PDF (see below for source)
- Table display of country flags / groups
- Colour illustrations of all EU country flags in small format for sticking on, sorted by accession, without dates
- Checklist with data for EU country accessions

Note:

The following websites were primarily used as sources for the research:

https://european-union.europa.eu/index_en

Memory games:

https://europa.eu/kids-corner/games-brexit/memory_landmark/assets/pdf/memory-game-offline-LANDMARK_DE.pdf

(https://europa.eu/learning-corner/match-the-landmarks_en)

https://europa.eu/kids-corner/games-brexit/memory_flag/assets/pdf/memory-game-offline-flags_de.pdf

(https://learning-corner.learning.europa.eu/learning-materials/match-flags_en)

www.bpb.de (Bundeszentrale für politische Bildung, Germany)